

RICH TILLMAN

Principal Frontend Engineer

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SUMMARY

Principal Frontend Engineer with 15 years building production UI systems, specializing in React/TypeScript design systems and Storybook-driven development. Creator of ForgeKit, an open-source CLI + MCP server suite bridging Figma to React (5,700+ npm installs). IC to Engineering Director across five 0-to-1 startups. Ships products end-to-end, frontend-deep and self-sufficient across the stack. Seeking Principal / Senior Frontend, Product Engineer, and design-systems / developer-tooling roles.

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Engineer, AI Evaluation & Red-Teaming (Contract) — Handshake

Jun 2026 - Jul 2026

- Assessed real-world code quality and red-teamed AI models on frontend/React engineering tasks, authoring adversarial cases to break model outputs and surface failure modes.

Frontend Engineer, AI Model Evaluation (Contract) — micro1

Apr 2026 - May 2026

- Ranked and scored AI model outputs against evaluation rubrics on React/TypeScript coding tasks, with adversarial testing to expose model weaknesses.

Frontend Engineer, AI Model Evaluation (Contract) — Mercor

Feb 2026 - Mar 2026

- Evaluated and ranked AI model outputs against scoring rubrics on advanced frontend/React tasks; probed models with adversarial cases to surface failure modes.

Staff Frontend Engineer & Tech Lead to Engineering Director — Redesign Health

Jul 2022 - May 2024

- Promoted twice to Engineering Director; led delivery across three cross-functional teams (15+ members) while staying hands-on as a frontend architecture SME.
- Spearheaded a React design system of 50+ reusable components (Storybook + Chromatic) adopted across teams: 30% dev-time reduction across a 10-15 engineer org.
- Engineered 20+ data-visualization components with custom hooks and Zustand: 40% rendering-overhead reduction on large datasets; established a Chromatic visual-regression workflow.
- Built an onboarding methodology that trained backend engineers to production-level React in one month.

Senior Frontend Engineer & Tech Lead — Pineapple Corporation

Jan 2022 - Jul 2022

- Architected an Nx monorepo with shared libraries across 8+ applications (35% version-control efficiency gain); Storybook + Chromatic workflow for 60+ components; standardized state with Redux Toolkit.
- Built cross-platform architecture with Expo, Nx, and React Native (25% mobile performance gain for 100K+ users).

Founding Frontend Engineer — PHC Global

Jul 2021 - Jan 2022

- Set the foundational frontend architecture for a B2B fintech dashboard: Nx monorepo with 30+ shared libraries and gRPC middleware (40% developer-experience improvement); lifted NPS-measured satisfaction 35%; cut infrastructure costs 30% via GCP, gRPC, and Kubernetes.

Lead Frontend Engineer — Freebird

Sep 2016 - Jan 2021

- Built one of the earliest production React UI libraries on Storybook: a 200-component design system spanning B2B, B2C, and React Native, eliminating the need for separate iOS and Android teams.
- Served as design-engineering liaison across client, sales, and marketing; shipped B2B/B2C and internal dashboards (React, NestJS, D3.js) and a React Native app with real-time data views.

Lead Web Developer — FaceCake Marketing Technologies

Oct 2010 - Sep 2016 | Los Angeles, CA

- Pioneered browser-based AR try-on for NARS: compiled OpenCV to JavaScript via Emscripten for real-time client-side computer vision over getUserMedia, years before mainstream WebAR.
- Shipped the NARS virtual try-on web app (~\$400K/month revenue lift) backed by a real-time CMS on Firebase Realtime Database; owned the full lifecycle end-to-end.

PROJECTS

ForgeKit - independent open-source developer-tooling venture (2024 - 2026) — Open-source CLI + MCP server suite bridging Figma to React to Storybook for design-system teams. 5,700+ npm installs with active production adoption. forgekit.cloud, github.com/effinrich, npmjs.com.

ForgeKit Core CLI (forgekit.cloud) — TypeScript CLI scaffolding production-ready Nx monorepos with React 18, Storybook 10+, Vitest, Playwright, and GitHub Actions CI/CD; targets Chakra UI, shadcn/ui, and Tamagui across web and universal React Native. Used recursively to scaffold ForgeKit itself.

ForgeKit Figma MCP (npmjs.com) — MCP server extracting Figma variables and design tokens; generates typed theme configs for Chakra UI, Tailwind, and shadcn - enabling AI-driven design-to-code workflows.

ForgeKit Storybook MCP (npmjs.com) — MCP server exposing Storybook metadata, argTypes, and usage patterns to AI coding agents - automating story generation, docs scaffolding, and component-testing workflows.

Perch - open-source voice-assistant widget — Drop-in voice AI for any website (one script tag + React SDK) built on ElevenLabs Conversational AI: dependency-free Shadow-DOM core, React SDK, and a serverless signed-URL proxy that keeps the API key server-side.

MCP Atlas (mcp-atlas-orcin.vercel.app) — Curated, link-verified directory of Model Context Protocol servers (18 official + community, searchable and filterable). Built with Astro (Zod-validated content collections + islands architecture), TypeScript, Vitest, and Playwright; Lighthouse 100 accessibility, 97 performance.

TokenCast (tokencast.vercel.app) — Paste design tokens (Figma variables, CSS custom properties, or a Tailwind config) and get a live preview plus exportable theme code for Tailwind, Chakra, and shadcn/ui, with server-rendered Save & Share links. React Router (framework mode: SSR, loaders, actions), React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS 4, Supabase (RLS + SECURITY DEFINER RPCs, IP rate-limiting), Vitest + Playwright; Lighthouse 100 accessibility, 99 performance.

Tidy App (tidyapp.me) — Offline-first React Native + Expo app; Zustand + TanStack Query; Supabase; Figma Code Connect; 90% test coverage.

COVID-19 Hotspot Mapping — Interactive thermal-style heat maps of COVID-19 hotspots and zones built on Mapbox GL, turning geospatial case data into a clear public-health visualization.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (15 yrs), TypeScript (strict), HTML5, CSS3, SQL, PHP (legacy)

Frameworks & Libraries: React 19, Next.js, React Native, Expo, TanStack Start, Node.js / NestJS, React Hooks, Concurrent Rendering

Design Systems & Tools: Storybook 10+, Chromatic, Chakra UI, shadcn/ui, Tamagui, Ark UI, Radix UI, Styled Components / CSS-in-JS, Figma Code Connect

AI & Tooling: Model Context Protocol (MCP), Claude Code, Cursor, Figma MCP, AI model evaluation & red-teaming

DevOps & Monorepo: Nx, Turborepo, pnpm workspaces, Module Federation, GitHub Actions, EAS Build, GCP, Kubernetes, gRPC

State & Data: Redux Toolkit, Zustand, TanStack Query, REST, GraphQL, tRPC, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Context API

Testing & Accessibility: Vitest, Jest, Playwright, React Testing Library, WCAG 2.1 AA